Cover Letter — Journal of Systems and Software

Date: November 2026

To: The Editors-in-Chief, Journal of Systems and Software

Subject: Submission of an original research article — “Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations”

Dear Editor,

Please consider the enclosed manuscript, “Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations”, for publication in *Journal of Systems and Software*.

LLM agents increasingly act on production systems that cannot undo or de-duplicate their actions. Consumer publishing platforms offer no idempotency key for web submission, so an agent that retries an uncertain upload can publish twice. Following Design Science Research, we design and evaluate a four-layer governance architecture implemented in two open-source artifacts, Agentic Work Lab and PublishOps CrossCast: a deterministic admission gate, binding of each release command to the digest of the reviewed plan, a receipt state machine that is saved as UNKNOWN before the single final submission and never re-submits automatically, and independent read-back with escalation to a person.

We evaluate the framework in a nine-day field deployment (26 October–3 November 2026) in one creator–engineering laboratory. A 69-record operational journal records one platform write and no replayed upload; when Douyin's programmatic read-back timed out after the single final submission, the receipt stayed UNKNOWN, nothing was re-submitted, and the owner confirmed the work by phone. In one instrumented Instagram publication, 92.32% of the 412.217 s publish command was the wait after Share. The evaluated release software (PublishOps CrossCast, commit 75b7abc) carries 2,737 offline test functions, and 30 video versions (2.21 GB) are archived with recorded SHA-256 digests.

For JSS readers, the contribution is a reusable engineering pattern for agentic release operations: at-most-once submission with an explicit proposition and its assumptions, mapped to concrete code and an offline test suite, together with a reproducible evidence package.

The study is a single-case design science evaluation. We state the assumptions under which automated re-submission cannot occur, report every figure descriptively, keep human-led and AI-assisted cohorts apart rather than comparing them causally, and publish the data, code and a script that recomputes every reported figure.

The manuscript (22 pages, 11 tables, 5 figures, 3 algorithms) is accompanied by online supplementary material. It is original, has not been published previously, and is not under consideration elsewhere.

Sincerely,

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Cover Letter — IEEE Transactions on Engineering Management

Date: November 2026

To: The Editor-in-Chief, IEEE Transactions on Engineering Management

Subject: Submission of an original research article — “Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations”

Dear Editor,

Please consider the enclosed manuscript, “Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations”, for publication in *IEEE Transactions on Engineering Management*.

Engineering managers who delegate delivery work to AI agents must decide who may authorize an irreversible step and on what evidence. Following Design Science Research and stage-gate control theory, we formalize four software-enforced governance layers for human–AI collaborative delivery and implement them in two open-source artifacts, Agentic Work Lab and PublishOps CrossCast. We read stage gates as commit protocols: admission control at the gate, content binding of approvals, at-most-once commitment, end-to-end verification, and human resolution of in-doubt outcomes.

We evaluate the framework in a nine-day field deployment (26 October–3 November 2026) in one creator–engineering laboratory. A 69-record operational journal records one platform write and no replayed upload; when Douyin's programmatic read-back timed out after the single final submission, the receipt stayed UNKNOWN, nothing was re-submitted, and the owner confirmed the work by phone. In one instrumented Instagram publication, 92.32% of the 412.217 s publish command was the wait after Share. The evaluated release software (PublishOps CrossCast, commit 75b7abc) carries 2,737 offline test functions, and 30 video versions (2.21 GB) are archived with recorded SHA-256 digests.

For IEEE TEM readers, the contribution links technology-management theory on stage gates, configuration management and human–automation authority to an operational design whose behaviour can be checked, and it shows where human work moves when automation is made safe.

The study is a single-case design science evaluation. We state the assumptions under which automated re-submission cannot occur, report every figure descriptively, keep human-led and AI-assisted cohorts apart rather than comparing them causally, and publish the data, code and a script that recomputes every reported figure.

The manuscript (22 pages, 11 tables, 5 figures, 3 algorithms) is accompanied by online supplementary material. It is original, has not been published previously, and is not under consideration elsewhere.

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Cover Letter — International Journal of Project Management

Date: November 2026

To: The Editors, International Journal of Project Management

Subject: Submission of an original research article — “Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations”

Dear Editor,

Please consider the enclosed manuscript, “Governing Human–AI Collaborative Project Workflows in Multi-Platform Digital Delivery: A Design Science Study of Auditable Handoffs and Idempotent Release Operations”, for publication in *International Journal of Project Management*.

Project governance research separates the framework that assigns decision rights from the management of execution. When AI agents execute project work, that separation must hold at the moment of action. Following Design Science Research, we design and evaluate a human-in-the-loop governance framework for multi-agent, multi-platform delivery, implemented in two open-source artifacts, Agentic Work Lab and PublishOps CrossCast, and we propose reading stage gates as commit protocols in which approvals bind to content and irreversible steps happen at most once.

We evaluate the framework in a nine-day field deployment (26 October–3 November 2026) in one creator–engineering laboratory. A 69-record operational journal records one platform write and no replayed upload; when Douyin's programmatic read-back timed out after the single final submission, the receipt stayed UNKNOWN, nothing was re-submitted, and the owner confirmed the work by phone. In one instrumented Instagram publication, 92.32% of the 412.217 s publish command was the wait after Share. The evaluated release software (PublishOps CrossCast, commit 75b7abc) carries 2,737 offline test functions, and 30 video versions (2.21 GB) are archived with recorded SHA-256 digests.

For IJPM readers, the contribution extends project governance and stage-gate theory to AI-executed project work and demonstrates a reporting protocol that keeps descriptive project evidence apart from causal claims about AI.

The study is a single-case design science evaluation. We state the assumptions under which automated re-submission cannot occur, report every figure descriptively, keep human-led and AI-assisted cohorts apart rather than comparing them causally, and publish the data, code and a script that recomputes every reported figure.

The manuscript (22 pages, 11 tables, 5 figures, 3 algorithms) is accompanied by online supplementary material. It is original, has not been published previously, and is not under consideration elsewhere.

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